

phone.

Andrea looked around the small room that served as their living area. There sat the television and stereo she had charged on the credit card before she and Bill were married, and she realized that she probably *had* charged four thousand dollars—and more. She had been using the card since they got married and was frightened as she realized that they may well have charged another several hundred dollars. Graduation was still five weeks away, and without income they would have no way to make payments on their credit card bill. She decided not to tell Bill anything about what her mother had said until after graduation. He needed to concentrate on end-of-semester matters, and she knew he would worry himself sick about the bills. He already looked haggard from concern over what he would tell his parents.

For nearly two weeks Andrea tried diligently not to use the credit card for anything. Her mother had sent her the bills, and after looking through them, she knew they were her charges. Then one evening while Bill was in a class, she got a call on her cell phone from Bill's mother.

"Andrea, I'm trying to find Bill. Is he with you?" she asked.

Without thinking, Andrea replied, "No, he's still in class. He'll be home later this afternoon."

There was a long pause on the other end of the line. Andrea tried to think of something to say, but decided that this was as good a time as any for Bill's mother to find out.

"Are you and Bill living together?" Bill's mother asked with a measured calmness.

"Well, Mrs. Yates, we have good news for you! We got married about a month ago," Andrea replied. "I know we should have told you both right away, but, well ... we decided so fast, and—we've both been so busy," she finished lamely.

"We knew something was going on when the school e-mailed and told us Bill had moved out of the dorm," she said sternly. "I do think you both owed us enough respect to tell us yourselves. But if you're